System & Boot Troubleshooting

Q1: Windows 10 won't boot and shows a "No Boot Device" error. What do I do? A: Check your BIOS/UEFI settings to ensure your SSD/HDD is detected. Ensure the boot order is correct. If the drive is visible but won't boot, use a Windows Installation Media to run "Startup Repair."

Q2: How can I fix a "Blue Screen of Death" (BSOD) that keeps recurring? A: Note the "Stop Code" provided. Boot into Safe Mode and uninstall recently added drivers or software. Run `sfc /scannow` in Command Prompt to fix corrupted system files.

Q3: My computer is stuck in a "Preparing Automatic Repair" loop. A: Hard shut down the PC three times to trigger Advanced Startup Options. Navigate to Troubleshoot > Advanced Options > System Restore, or try "Startup Settings" to boot into Safe Mode and disable failing drivers.

Q4: How do I access Safe Mode if Windows won't load the desktop? A: On the sign-in screen, hold the **Shift** key while selecting Power > Restart. Once the PC restarts to the "Choose an option" screen, select Troubleshoot > Advanced options > Startup Settings > Restart.

Q5: Why is my Start Menu or Taskbar not responding? A: Open Task Manager (Ctrl+Shift+Esc), find "Windows Explorer," right-click it, and select "Restart." If that fails, run PowerShell as admin and use the command: `Get-AppXPackage -AllUsers | Foreach {Add-AppxPackage -DisableDevelopmentMode -Register "$($_.InstallLocation)\AppXManifest.xml"}`.

⚡ Performance & Disk Space

Q6: How can I fix 100% Disk Usage in Task Manager? A: Disable the "SysMain" (formerly Superfetch) and "Connected User Experiences" services. Run `chkdsk /f /r` to check for drive errors. Ensure all Windows Updates and AHCI drivers are installed.

Q7: My laptop is running extremely slow after a recent update. A: Go to Settings > Update & Security > Recovery and select "Go back to the previous version of Windows 10." Alternatively, check for background processes like "Carbon Black" or "Windows Search" indexing that may be overusing resources.

Q8: How do I quickly clear huge amounts of "System & Reserved" storage? A: Run "Disk Cleanup" and click "Clean up system files." Delete old Windows Installation files (Windows.old). Also, reduce the space allocated to System Protection/Restore Points in System Properties.

Q9: Windows is lagging when I open multiple developer tools. How do I optimize RAM? A: Open Task Manager > Startup and disable unnecessary apps. Increase your Virtual Memory (Page File) size on your fastest SSD. Ensure your power plan is set to "High Performance."

Q10: How do I stop Windows from automatically restarting for updates? A: Go to Settings > Update & Security > Windows Update > Change active hours. Set the hours you are working so Windows knows not to reboot during those times.

🌐 Networking & Connectivity

Q11: My Wi-Fi says "Connected, no internet." How do I fix this? A: Right-click the Wi-Fi icon and select "Troubleshoot problems." If that fails, open Command Prompt as admin and type `netsh winsock reset` followed by `ipconfig /flushdns`, then restart your PC.

Q12: How do I fix a "DNS Probe Finished No Internet" error in Chrome? A: Manually set your DNS to Google's (8.8.8.8 and 8.8.4.4) in Network and Sharing Center. Alternatively, clear your browser cache and restart your router.

Q13: My Ethernet port isn't detected at all. A: Check Device Manager to see if the Network Adapter is disabled or has a yellow exclamation mark. Right-click it to "Update driver" or "Uninstall device" and restart to let Windows reinstall it.

Q14: Why does my VPN keep disconnecting on Windows 10? A: Disable "IPv6" in your Network Adapter properties. Ensure your Firewall isn't blocking the VPN client. Check if the "WAN Miniport" drivers in Device Manager need to be uninstalled and refreshed.

Q15: How do I reset all network settings to factory defaults? A: Go to Settings > Network & Internet > Status. Scroll down to the bottom and click "Network reset." This will remove and reinstall all network adapters.

🛠️ Developer & Advanced Troubleshooting

Q16: IIS Express won't start because a port is already in use. A: Run `netstat -ano | findstr :yourportnumber` to find the PID. Kill the process in Task Manager, or run `net stop winnat` followed by `net start winnat` to clear reserved ports.

Q17: WSL2 (Linux) stopped working after a Windows Update. A: Run `wsl --shutdown` in PowerShell. Ensure "Virtual Machine Platform" and "Windows Subsystem for Linux" are still checked in "Turn Windows features on or off." Run `wsl --update`.

Q18: How do I fix "Access Denied" when trying to delete a file in Program Files? A: Right-click the folder > Properties > Security > Advanced. Change the "Owner" to your username, check "Replace owner on subcontainers," and grant yourself "Full Control."

Q19: Visual Studio is crashing during the "loading project" phase. A: Delete the hidden `.vs` folder in your solution directory. This clears the local cache. If that fails, run the "Visual Studio Installer" and select "Repair."

Q20: How do I disable the Windows Defender real-time scan for a specific folder? A: Go to Windows Security > Virus & threat protection > Manage settings > Exclusions. Add your project or Docker folder to prevent the antivirus from slowing down your builds.

🔊 Audio & Peripheral Problems

Q21: There is no sound coming from my speakers after an update. A: Right-click the volume icon > Sounds > Playback tab. Ensure the correct device is set as "Default." If it's missing, reinstall the Realtek High Definition Audio driver from Device Manager.

Q22: My microphone is plugged in but Windows isn't picking up sound. A: Go to Settings > Privacy > Microphone. Ensure "Allow apps to access your microphone" is toggled ON. Check the "Input" device settings in System > Sound.

Q23: Why is my Bluetooth device paired but not connecting? A: Remove the device from Bluetooth settings. Open `services.msc` and ensure "Bluetooth Support Service" is running and set to Automatic. Re-pair the device.

Q24: My webcam shows a black screen or an error code. A: Check the physical privacy slider on the laptop. Go to Settings > Privacy > Camera and ensure access is granted. Update the camera driver in Device Manager.

Q25: The keyboard is typing the wrong characters (e.g., @ instead of "). A: Your keyboard layout is likely set to the wrong region (e.g., UK instead of US). Go to Settings > Time & Language > Language. Ensure your preferred language is at the top and check the "Options" for the correct layout.

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